

Community of Practice T&L

Meeting 6

17 June 2026

Due to schedule of upcoming CoP meetings, the following to meetings will combine two topics of inquiry within the same session, the following session (meeting 7) will focus on International and Competition, with the 8th (and final) meeting ending the CoP meetings with wrapping up all meetings into a strategic output.

Meeting #	Topic if Inquiry
1	Intros
2	What are we good at, what do we improve on, what do we let go of
3	technology
4	Student Experience
5	Indigenous Knowledge
6	(c)reativity
7	Interdisciplinarity
8	International
10	Competition

In this meeting (number 6), the CoP T&L focused on Creativity and Interdisciplinarity as a Topic of Inquiry. Throughout previous discussions, creativity emerged as one of the Faculty's distinguishing characteristics, alongside recurring conversations around adaptability, critical thinking, student agency, industry engagement, technology and uncertain futures. Interdisciplinarity similarly emerged as both a strength and an opportunity for the Faculty, offering new ways to enrich learning, address complex challenges and create distinctive educational experiences. Critical to this is that although the faculty's recent merger was driven by 'creative industries', there are a number of 'non-creative' (in the traditional sense) disciplines that are part of the faculty and therefore it is critical that the strategy for the faculty is inclusive of all disciplines.

The session explored how creativity and interdisciplinarity contribute to the identity of the Faculty and considered how these strengths can be further embedded into teaching and learning, curriculum design, student experience and future-facing educational models. The discussion was guided by the following questions:

1. What are we great at?
2. What do we want to be great at?
3. What should we move beyond?

Below is the summary of Meeting 6.

What are we Great at

Creativity as a Core Graduate Capability

- The Faculty produces graduates who are highly capable creative problem-solvers. Industry regularly recognises and values the ability of our graduates to approach problems in innovative and unexpected ways.
- UTS graduates are often perceived as more creative than graduates from comparable institutions.
- Rather than directing students toward predetermined outcomes, our teaching culture encourages students to explore their own interests, ideas and directions.
- Students are given agency and autonomy within learning experiences:
 - Academics curate the brief while still providing space for students to challenge assumptions and develop their own responses.
 - Creativity is embedded within core subjects rather than being isolated to elective experiences.
- When our students are given the opportunity and support to think creatively, they consistently exceed expectations and demonstrate innovative approaches to complex challenges.

Student Agency and Independence

- Students are encouraged to develop their own voice and create work that reflects their generation and lived experiences.
- Rather than reproducing established ideas or perspectives, students are empowered to contribute to emerging cultural conversations and create new forms of practice.
- This emphasis on independence and agency is a defining characteristic of the Faculty's teaching approach.

Institutional Freedom and Creative Teaching

- The Faculty provides significant freedom for academics to develop and deliver subjects in creative and innovative ways.
- This flexibility allows academics to experiment with curriculum, assessment and delivery models that foster creativity and support diverse student outcomes.

Disciplinary Excellence

- Several disciplines within the Faculty were identified as leaders within their fields, with particular recognition given to Fashion, Visual Communication and Screen Production as examples of highly regarded and respected programs.

What Do We Want To Be Great At?

Interdisciplinary Learning and Collaboration

- Interdisciplinarity represents one of the greatest opportunities available to the Faculty.
- While students already benefit from exposure to different disciplines, there is significant potential for academics to learn from one another and share approaches to creativity, teaching and curriculum design.
- Cross-disciplinary teaching has significant potential to:
 - Expose students to alternative ways of thinking and working.

- Prepare graduates for careers that increasingly extend beyond traditional disciplinary boundaries.
 - Create opportunities for students to apply disciplinary expertise in new contexts.
- Creating and facilitating cross-disciplinary teaching models, including co-teaching arrangements that bring together academics from different disciplines within the same learning environment.

Culture, Creativity and Future Work

- Discussions around technology and AI can sometimes overshadow the cultural dimensions of creativity.
 - Creativity is deeply connected to culture, identity and human experience. It is essential to ensure that these dimensions remain central to the Faculty's identity.
- Not all disciplines within the Faculty identify as belonging to the “Creative Industries” and have, at times, felt marginalised by the language and framing that has accompanied when the faculties merged.
 - While disciplines may not identify with ‘conventional’ notion of Creativity; creative thinking, creative problem-solving and creative outputs occur across all disciplines within the Faculty.
 - Creativity should therefore be understood broadly, recognising that students are encouraged to think both creatively and critically, and that creativity can take many different forms depending on disciplinary context.
- Professions will continue to change significantly over time; developing adaptable graduates who can navigate uncertainty remains a key priority.
 - Interdisciplinary thinking is an important mechanism for preparing students for rapidly changing futures.

Creative Environments and Infrastructure

- The physical environment plays a significant role in supporting creativity.
- The physical space that students occupy must foster experimentation, collaboration and creative exchange. These can be:
 - Improving collaborative spaces across the Faculty.
 - Creating stronger connections between disciplines through shared environments.
 - Improving the visibility of creative activity across campus.
 - Providing infrastructure that supports both collaboration and independent creative practice.
- As a city campus, part of an international city branded as a 24/7 city, closing the buildings at 10pm inhibits creative processes and does not leverage the campus’s location.

Supporting Creative Practice

- Time is one of the most fundamental factors to foster creative thinking. Smaller class sizes allow for more time for students and tutors to engage with one another for more greater opportunities for creative development.
 - Class sizes of approximately 16–20 students per tutor provide particularly strong conditions for creative learning.

Technology and Creative Tools

- Access to emerging creative technologies remains important in supporting student learning and employability.

- It is very important that students and staff have access to contemporary tools and platforms while maintaining a critical and human-centred approach to their use.
- Much of these new tools have financial implications that students cannot afford, institutional support should be put in place at faculty level to address these issues.

Visibility, Community and Global Engagement

- Community engagement should be recognised as an important component of creative practice and learning.
- There are significant opportunities to bring communities into classrooms and create stronger connections between community engagement and industry engagement.
- The effort required to build and maintain community relationships should be recognised and supported.
- There is value in promoting student work more broadly, both nationally and internationally, and creating greater visibility for student achievements.

Flexible Modes of Learning

- There remains an ongoing tension between the value of in-person learning and increasing demand for online and hybrid delivery.
- Greater institutional support is needed to help academics deliver high-quality hybrid learning experiences while managing workload expectations.

What Should We Move Beyond?

Disciplinary Silos

- Disciplinary silos continue to create barriers for students and staff to engage in interdisciplinary learning and collaboration.
- Many opportunities for collaboration are perceived as being too difficult to implement due to administrative and organisational barriers.

Administrative Barriers

- Administrative processes and bureaucracy are often significant barriers to creativity and innovation.
- Greater flexibility and local agency would create more opportunities for experimentation, collaboration and interdisciplinary initiatives.

Technology as the Dominant Lens

- Creativity should not become synonymous with technology.
- While emerging technologies and AI have an important role to play, there should continue to be space for students to engage in creative work that is independent of AI-assisted processes.
- There is value in dedicating learning experiences that focus on non-AI approaches to creative thinking and practice.